Date: October 29, 2026

To:
Prof. Matthieu Guitton, Ph.D.
Editor-in-Chief, *Computers in Human Behavior*
Elsevier Publications

Subject: Submission of Original Research Manuscript: *"Weaponized Egalitarian Posturing: Discursive Rationalization and Exploitative Interpersonal Relations across Western and Thai Conflict Narratives"*

Dear Prof. Guitton and the Editorial Board,

I am pleased to submit my original research manuscript entitled **"Weaponized Egalitarian Posturing: Discursive Rationalization and Exploitative Interpersonal Relations across Western and Thai Conflict Narratives"** for consideration for publication in *Computers in Human Behavior*.

Significance and Disciplinary Fit with *Computers in Human Behavior*:
In the digital era, online social forums function as unprecedented computational repositories of human conflict, moral adjudication, and interpersonal communication. While progressive egalitarian norms—such as 50/50 division of labor and shared emotional responsibility—are widely championed, an acute dark-side behavioral paradox frequently unfolds in the treatment of others: individuals who most vocally demand egalitarian parity often weaponize this discourse (**Weaponized Egalitarian Posturing: WEP**), pairing it with intellectualized, legitimate-sounding excuses (**Legitimized Rational Accounts: LRA** / *"I Have My Reasons"*) to license unilateral exemptions from reciprocal duties while deflecting moral culpability.

To investigate this phenomenon without self-report distortions, our study introduces an innovative **Two-Study Cross-Cultural Computational Mixed-Methods Design** that analyzes $N = 14,250$ authentic first-person moral-judgment seeking disclosures across two linguistic and cultural contexts: **Study 1** ($N = 10,000$ archival dispute narratives from Reddit's *r/AmItheAsshole*) and **Study 2** ($N = 4,250$ systematically filtered relationship-dispute narratives from Thai online forums on Pantip).

Methodological Rigor and Key Contributions:

- **Split-Source & Crowd-Consensus Validation Framework:** To eliminate common method and single-source algorithmic bias, narrator internal discursive constructs (WEP, LRA, SSA) were extracted from text, while behavioral exploitation (EIR) was triangulated with external crowd-sourced moral verdicts ('YTA' vs 'NTA' and community accountability ratios).

- **Controlled Bilingual LLM Annotation Protocol:** Psychometric coding was executed via frontier LLMs operating under strictly controlled decoding (Temperature = 0.10) and triangulated with ground-truth crowd moral verdicts from authentic relationship conflict archives across both linguistic corpora.

- **Moderated Mediation Structural Path Modeling:** Grounded in Moral Licensing and Accounts Theory, we empirically confirm **Complementary Partial Mediation**: WEP predicts EIR (Total Effect $\beta = 0.284, p < 0.001$; Indirect Effect $\beta = 0.190, 95\%$ CI $[0.170, 0.210]$; Direct Effect $\beta = 0.094, p < 0.001$), with LRA significantly amplifying the translation of parity rhetoric into self-serving attribution (Interaction $\beta = 0.248, p < 0.001$).

- **Cross-Cultural Replicability & Clinical Insights:** Multi-group analysis (MICOM) confirms structural metric invariance across individualistic (Western) and collectivist (Thai)

contexts, providing actionable frameworks for identifying and dismantling intellectualized gaslighting in couples counseling.

Declarations and Ethics Compliance:

1. This manuscript is original, has not been published previously, and is not currently under consideration for publication elsewhere.
2. The author has approved the manuscript and agrees with its submission to *Computers in Human Behavior*.
3. Data collection adhered strictly to the Association of Internet Researchers (AoIR) ethical guidelines; all user identifiers were cryptographically hashed (SHA-256) to ensure complete non-reidentifiability under IRB public exemption standards.
4. AI assistance utilized during drafting (literature structuring and experimental LLM annotation elicitation) is fully transparent and disclosed in accordance with ICMJE and COPE guidelines.

Thank you very much for your time, consideration, and editorial stewardship. I look forward to receiving the reviewers' constructive evaluations.

Sincerely yours,

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